

Government AI Readiness Index **2025**

Methodology Report



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Acknowledgements

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Authors:

Kate Iida
Sulamaan Rahim
Annys Rogerson

Advisory Council:

- **Anir Chowdhury**, advisor to Bangladesh AI transformation programme
- **Gina Neff**, Executive Director of the Minderoo Centre for Technology and Democracy at the University of Cambridge
- **Laurence Liew**, Director of AI Innovation, AI Singapore
- **Sally Radwan**, Trustee, Alan Turing Institute
- **Winston Ojenge**, Senior research fellow and Head of the digital economy programme at the African Centre for Technology Studies (ACTS)
- **Yolanda Martinez**, Practice Manager for Digital Development in Latin America and the Caribbean at the World Bank

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please contact research@oxfordinsights.com



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Measuring Government AI Readiness

Section 1: High Level Framework

Tackling a New Research Question

In previous editions of the Index, our concept of ‘**government AI readiness**’ has focused on how ready a government is to implement AI in public services. This year, we are updating the exam question of the Index. Our central focus remains on the role of governments in AI, but we now aim to answer:

To what extent can a government harness AI to benefit the public?

There are three main reasons for our update.

Firstly, while using AI in the delivery of public services is one key way for governments to bring benefits to the public from AI, it is not the only one. AI has broader benefits for the public from improving education to advancing healthcare.¹

In delivering these benefits, the government plays multiple roles. For example, it can act as a direct buyer of AI technologies from private companies as well as developing them itself. Or, the government might act as an enabler or promoter of AI within critical sectors or civil society, leading to AI’s diffusion throughout the wider economy.

Secondly, as noted above, the positive outcomes of AI are not inevitable; and any question seeking to assess AI readiness must take this into account. As AI is adopted more widely, for more consequential use cases, and exhibits greater capabilities, it also creates challenges at a greater scale and severity. The government’s role extends to mitigating AI’s individual and societal harms as well as managing the transition to an economy and society that uses AI. A narrow focus on implementation in public services fails to capture this.

Finally, we believe the new question better matches how our audience would like to use the Index. Governments look to our framework for holistic, actionable recommendations about how they should respond to this rapidly evolving technology. By broadening our focus to the many different roles of government in AI, we believe that the Index will better serve this function for governments.

¹ Islam, M., (2024). Utilizing AI for Social Good: Tackling Global Issues and Fostering Inclusive Solutions. *Journal of Artificial Intelligence General Science (JAIGS)* 3(1), 341–362. doi: 10.60087/jaigs.v3i1.124

The many roles of government

Governments have a role to play in AI. The precise nature of that role differs from country to country and political system to political system. Some governments may put more weight on being promoters and enablers of AI development, others on being guarantors of AI risk mitigation, and others on being enablers of public engagement with AI.²

Our framework is normative, in the sense that it captures the set of things that governments *should* think about to be AI-ready. However, we aim to be agonistic in regards to the way governments apply this. Given governments work in diverse contexts, creating varied roles and priorities, there are a number of unique paths towards AI readiness.

Therefore, we have included measures across a breadth of policy instruments, economic measures, and regulatory approaches. For example, while some governments may choose to develop a legal framework to regulate AI, others may use soft law programmes to meet similar societal goals.³ Similarly, measurement of such exciting and varied AI pathways is complex. And we will be further refining our approach in 2026.

Alongside this, we have retained a strong focus on measuring positive outcomes of AI, encouraging governments to work towards these in the ways that fit their system. This does not mean, however, that we think anything is fair game. Alongside these positive outcomes, our measures capture whether or not they are achieved while people's rights and freedoms are being upheld, social institutions are not being eroded, and national security is being protected.

Theory of Change: what makes an AI-ready government?

An AI-ready government is one that is able to harness AI to benefit the public. But how does a government go about doing this?

We understand an AI-ready government to be one that uses its **policy capacity** to take up a role in how AI shapes its country and affects the public. In brief, it pulls particular levers. These levers involve safeguarding the public interest through **governance** measures, and securing **AI infrastructure** to drive and guarantee the long term security of the country's use of AI. In turn, this allows the government to take a supporting role in **public sector adoption** of AI as well as the **development and diffusion** of AI technologies throughout the economy. Part of managing this adoption and diffusion is creating the **resilience** within society and the economy for AI to bring widespread public benefits in critical economic sectors and domains of public life.

² Ulnicane, I., Knight, W., Leach, T., Stahl, B.C. and Wanjiku, W.G. (2021). Framing governance for a contested emerging technology: Insights from AI policy. *Policy and Society*, 40(2), 158–177.

³ Djeffal, C., Siewert, M.B. and Wurster, S. (2022). Role of the state and responsibility in governing artificial intelligence: A comparative analysis of AI strategies. *Journal of European Public Policy*, 29(11), 1799–1821.

This theory of change leads to six interrelated Pillars, which come together to provide a holistic picture of AI readiness that is sensitive to the measurement challenges posed by novel AI technologies.

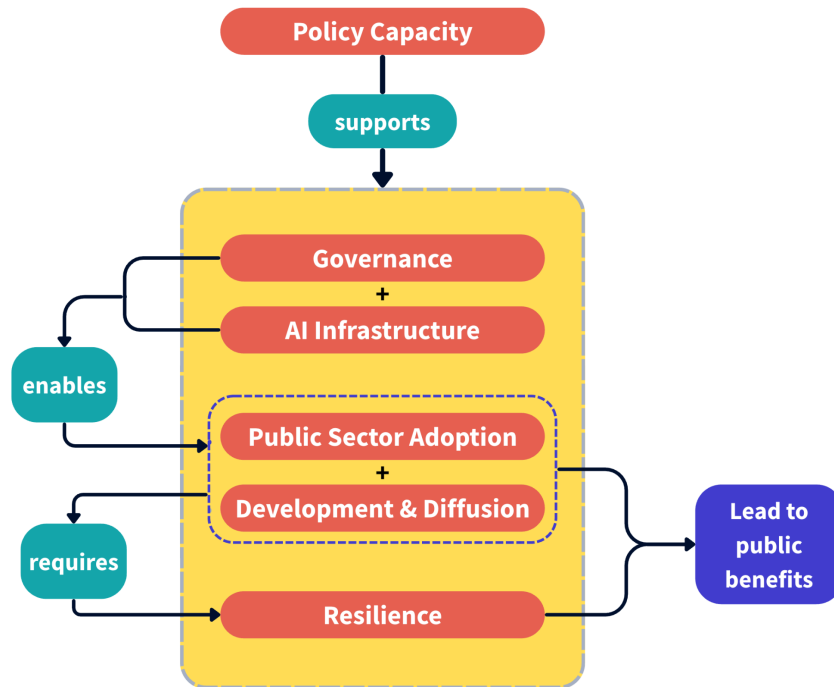


Figure 1: Theory of Change relating government action on AI to public benefits from AI

Each Pillar outlined within our Theory of Change above breaks down into multiple constituent Dimensions. This section will introduce each of our six Pillars in turn, outlining how they contribute towards answering the exam question and highlighting the constituent Dimensions that comprise them.



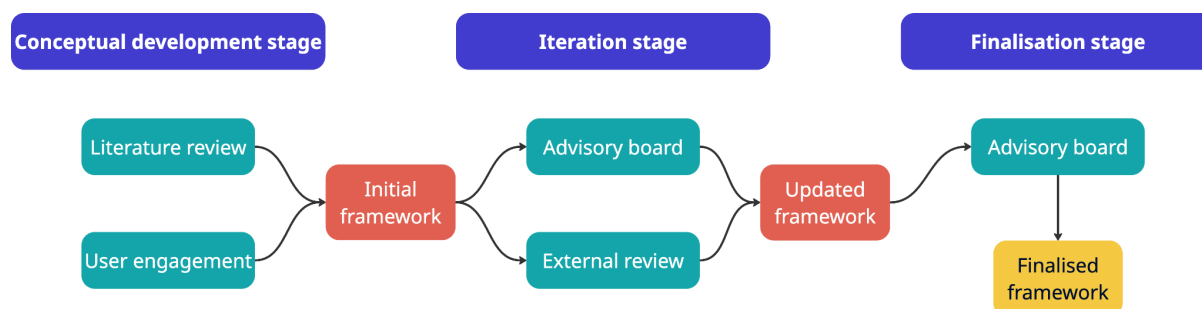
Figure 2. Framework highlighting six Pillars and fourteen constituent Dimensions

To what extent can a government harness AI to benefit the public? Each Pillar provides us with an answer.

Building: **To the extent that...**

Policy capacity	...the government can design and implement effective AI policies aligned with a clear, national policy vision for how AI benefits the country. It must demonstrate clear commitment to this policy by assigning resources to this vision and engaging in international cooperation to address AI's global nature.
Governance	...the government has clear governance principles that it promotes to shape how AI can be developed and adopted while protecting people's rights and societal interests. These principles are promoted through its own public sector practices and structures, supporting their wider implementation, and ensuring an adaptive environment for regulatory compliance with respect to AI.
AI Infrastructure	...there is adequate compute capacity and enabling technical infrastructure that the government and other actors can rely on over the long term to develop and use AI. There is sufficient, high-quality data for working on a wide range of problems using AI that is accessible and flows securely within and across the border.
Public Sector Adoption	...the government's digital policy encourages testing how AI can help to solve public sector challenges. Where AI proves effective, the government scales AI solutions, demonstrating this through its e-government delivery capabilities.
Development and Diffusion	...there is a mature AI sector that can meet the needs of local clients and consumers, and can push forward long-term AI innovation backed up by sufficient human capital to meet the demand for wider AI technology diffusion among industry players, researchers, and civil society who work on AI applications in their domains.
Resilience	...the government manages the social, economic, and environmental challenges brought by a societal transition towards widespread AI adoption. This includes actively monitoring and preparing for new risks to national safety and security as AI development and diffusion progresses.

Process for Developing the New Framework



The conceptual framework aims to capture the important contributors to governments' ability to harness AI even as the technology, its adoption, and society's relationship to AI change over time. However, it is likely that new indicators will emerge as capabilities, use cases, and risks evolve. Moreover, new datasets might emerge allowing us to more accurately measure certain indicators or move from proxies to direct measures.

Our conceptual framework was developed iteratively and through engagement with a number of expert advisors. Having decided upon our new question, we developed a theory of change starting from what we thought it meant for a government to be 'AI-ready' within this context. We then related government actions and outputs to beneficial outcomes of AI for the public. This was tested across three advisory board sessions with the following members:

- **Anir Chowdhury**, advisor to Bangladesh AI transformation programme
- **Gina Neff**, Executive Director of the Minderoo Centre for Technology and Democracy at the University of Cambridge
- **Laurence Liew**, Director of AI Innovation, AI Singapore
- **Sally Radwan**, Trustee, Alan Turing Institute
- **Winston Ojenge**, Senior research fellow and Head of the digital economy programme at the African Centre for Technology Studies (ACTS)
- **Yolanda Martinez**, Practice Manager for Digital Development in Latin America and the Caribbean at the World Bank

Our panel was gender equal and represented voices from across the Global North and South. This allowed us to continue to ensure our framework was sensitive to a breadth of global challenges rather than simply those affecting the Global North—a cornerstone of all iterations of this project.

Section 2. Data Collection

The data for this year's edition of the index came from three broad types of sources.

- First, secondary data taken from other relevant and reputable international indices. These data sources are detailed in the detailed framework provided in Section 3.
- Second, 19 desk research indicators, for which our team conducted the research ourselves.
- Third, for the first time this year we opened a window during data collection for countries to submit information and documentation that they met the requirements outlined in the indicators. The submitted information was cross-checked and verified by our research team and, where relevant, included in the index.

We intend to maintain a robust framework by improving what we measure over time. While we intend to keep the overarching framework constant, we will review inclusion of new indicators and data sources each year - and continue to aim for the Index to provide actionable guidance to governments, and countries, on their AI journeys.

Desk Research

To gather information for the desk research indicators, we used a combination of methods. To look for **relevant documents and information**, we conducted a search using the research function in Perplexity AI, and then verified the accuracy of the links provided. In addition, we also conducted a Google search to independently check for evidence of meeting the requirements for the indicator.

When looking for information for the desk research indicators focused on the **content of a country's National AI Strategy**, we used two methods. For strategies published in English, Spanish, French, and Arabic, languages of fluency for our researchers, we conducted keyword searches within the National Strategy documents to find relevant information.

For National Strategies not written in the above languages, we uploaded the document to Perplexity, and asked the AI model to search within the document and provide quotes and page numbers which pertained to the relevant indicators. We then cross checked the quote and page number within the document itself, and verified the translation using a secondary translator to check the accuracy of the translation provided.

Finally, for some of the countries included in the Index, we had limited access to official government sources due to geopolitical challenges and constraints. In these instances, we used information provided by other reputable sources, including UN reports and reputable news articles to score these countries in the desk research indicators.

How we use AI

At Oxford Insights, we see AI as a valuable and useful tool in the research process. In addition, we remain conscious of the need to use the technology in a trustworthy, safe, and reliable manner. We used AI in three elements of the research process for this year's edition of the Government AI Readiness Index. How we used AI, as well as the steps we took to ensure the reliability and rigor of the results, are outlined below.

Desk research

We used AI as part of the desk research process. In order to do this, our team used the research function in Perplexity AI to run an initial, web scraping search for information across each of the relevant desk research indicators. When doing this search, the team asked Perplexity to provide links to official government sources documenting its findings. In order to ensure the reliability and accuracy of the provided information, the research team checked all information provided by Perplexity against the official sources provided. The team also conducted additional Google searches to ensure that Perplexity had not missed any important documents

Language translation

The team also used Perplexity in the desk research process to search within documents that were not published in one of the languages of fluency for our researchers (English, French, Spanish, and Arabic). For National Strategies not written in the above languages, the research team uploaded the document to Perplexity. Perplexity was then asked to search within the document and provide quotes and page numbers which pertained to the relevant indicators. The team then cross checked the quote and page number within the document itself, and verified the translation using a secondary translator to check the accuracy of the translation provided.

Quality assurance

Finally, the team used Perplexity AI and Google Gemini as part of the quality assurance (QA) process for the final desk research data. The team provided Perplexity with the desk research scoring criteria and asked the model to do its own search and to check the score provided for a country against information it could find. This was in order to do a final check to make sure nothing had been missed and the scores were consistent. The team then manually reviewed all of the indicators flagged by Perplexity as potentially needing updated scores. The team then made an assessment based on the information provided about whether to accept the recommended updated score or to stay with the previously provided score.

Section 3. Data processing

Stage 1: Data Cleaning and Preliminary Processing

Upon collection, the raw secondary data underwent a cleaning process to ensure computational compatibility. This involved the conversion of all qualitative or non-numerical observations into quantitative values. Following this standardisation, the dataset was subjected to a series of statistical tests to assess its distribution and suitability for aggregation.

Skewness and Kurtosis Analysis

To ensure that extreme outliers or asymmetrical distributions did not disproportionately influence the final rankings, we conducted a skewness and kurtosis analysis for each indicator. In accordance with the OECD Handbook on Constructing Composite Indicators, we applied specific thresholds to identify problematic distributions.

Data was flagged for transformation if it exceeded the following criteria:

- Absolute Skewness: Higher than 2.0.
- Kurtosis: Higher than 3.5.

Where an indicator was identified as both skewed and continuous, a logarithmic transformation was applied to normalise the distribution. Discrete datasets were treated on a case-by-case basis to preserve their underlying logic.

Stage 2: Normalisation

To allow for the comparison of indicators with different units of measurement, all data were normalised onto a common scale of 0 to 100. This was achieved using the Min-Max normalisation method:

$$\text{Normalised Score} = [(\text{Value} - \text{Minimum Value}) / (\text{Maximum Value} - \text{Minimum Value})] \times 100$$

This ensures that the best-performing country in any given indicator receives a score of 100, while the lowest-performing receives 0.

Stage 3: Data Imputation

Once the datasets were unskewed and normalised, missing values were addressed using the peer-group mean imputation methodology. This order of operations, normalising prior to imputation, ensures that the imputed values are based on the adjusted, comparable scales of peer nations.

How we manage missing data

To ensure the broadest possible coverage, we utilised high-quality secondary datasets from reputable international organisations. Despite choosing datasets for their geographic breadth and accuracy, missing values remain a systemic challenge. In the majority of cases, these gaps are the result of non-reporting or discrepancies in data collection cycles at the primary source level, rather than a lack of relevance to the country in question.

It is important to note that this edition features a larger cohort of countries than previous iterations. In the previous edition, several nations were excluded due to insufficient data availability. In this version, improved data reporting and our refined harmonisation efforts have ensured that a greater number of countries met the threshold for inclusion, enhancing the global representative value of the index.

Our approach to missingness is guided by a principle of equitable representation. Rather than penalising countries for data gaps beyond their control, we utilise imputation (detailed [below](#)) to provide a "benefit of the doubt" estimation. This ensures that the final rankings reflect a country's likely performance based on its socio-economic context, rather than simply reflecting the limitations of global data infrastructure.

Unranked Countries

Where a country has imputed data for more than 50% of Indicators, however, we exclude this country from the final Index rankings. This includes countries where there may be >50% coverage but the data is out of date. We have set a threshold within the Index that 'out of date' data is data older than three years.

Peer Group Mean Imputation

To ensure a comprehensive comparison across the ranked countries, we addressed data gaps through peer-group mean imputation. This technique replaces missing observations with the average value of a specific subgroup, preserving the representative characteristics of countries with similar socio-economic profiles.

Countries were categorized into peer groups based on two primary dimensions: geographic region and income level. We adopted the World Bank Country and Lending Groups classification as the authoritative source for these categories:

- **Income Groups:** Countries are classified as Low, Lower-Middle, Upper-Middle, or High Income based on GNI per capita.
- **Regional Groups:** Countries are grouped into seven geographical regions (e.g., Sub-Saharan Africa, Europe, and Central Asia).

By applying the mean of the specific intersection (e.g., High Income countries in Europe & Central Asia), we mitigate the risk of "averaging out" significant developmental disparities that would occur if a global mean were used. For example, a missing value for R&D spending in the United Kingdom is substituted with the mean of its direct peers, such as France and Germany, rather than a global average.

We applied a conservative approach to binary indicators and categorical data. Imputation was strictly limited to continuous numerical variables:

- **Binary Data:** Where binary data (0/1) was missing, we assigned a value of zero rather than an average. This decision was made to avoid creating "artificial probabilities" (e.g., a value of 0.45) that lack physical meaning in a binary context and to ensure the final index remains grounded in confirmed data points.
- **Data Integrity:** This "conservative scoring" ensures that countries are not rewarded for features they have not definitively demonstrated.

Stage 4: Score Aggregation and Ranking

The final scores were calculated through a hierarchical aggregation process:

- **Indicator Level:** Scores within a single dimension were combined using a simple arithmetic mean.
- **Dimension and Pillar Level:** A weighted aggregation was employed to reflect the relative strategic importance of specific components.

Countries were ranked individually on a global scale, as well as within specific regional and income group cohorts. This multi-layered analysis provides a granular view of performance at the overall, pillar, dimension, and indicator levels.

Weightings

In previous iterations of the index, we took the arithmetic mean of all Pillars to come up with a final score. Each Pillar was in turn made up of the arithmetic mean of all its Dimensions and each Dimension the arithmetic mean of all its Indicators. This created implicit weightings of both Dimensions and Indicators as not all Pillars contained the same amount of Dimensions nor

Dimensions the same amount of Indicators. This year, we have decided to make our weightings explicit.

It is worth stressing here again that we are open to feedback and would appreciate engagement with these weightings as well as the rest of the framework. Our weightings reflect something normative about the way in which we have been thinking about AI readiness when developing this year's framework. That said, we are keen to keep the discussion live and continue to iterate our framework as our understanding changes.

We have decided to weight both Pillars as a whole and Dimensions as they contribute to those Pillars. This also results in explicit Dimension-level weightings across the Index as a whole. The table below demonstrates this approach.

Pillar	Pillar Weight %	Dimension	Dimension Weight %
Policy Capacity	10%	Policy Vision	4.00%
Policy Capacity		Policy Commitment	6.00%
AI Infrastructure	25%	Compute capacity	8.33%
AI Infrastructure		Enabling technical infrastructure	8.33%
AI Infrastructure		Data quality	8.33%
Governance	15%	Governance principles	7.50%
Governance		Regulatory compliance	7.50%
Public Sector Adoption	15%	Government digital policy	7.50%
Public Sector Adoption		e-Government delivery	7.50%
Development and Diffusion	25%	Human capital	7.50%
Development and Diffusion		AI sector maturity	10.00%
Development and Diffusion		AI technology diffusion	7.50%
Resilience	10%	Societal transition	5.00%
Resilience		Safety and security	5.00%

Section 4. Detailed Framework

Policy Capacity Pillar

To what extent can a government harness AI to benefit the public? To the extent that...

...the government can design and implement effective AI policies aligned with a clear, national **policy vision** for how AI benefits the country. It must demonstrate clear **commitment to this policy** by assigning resources to this vision and engaging in international cooperation to address AI's global nature.

Dimension: Policy Vision

Indicator: National AI Strategy

Rationale: In this indicator, we are looking for evidence that a country has an overarching strategy which demonstrates a country's high-level AI policy vision and a whole of government approach.⁴ This not only demonstrates that AI is a priority for the country but also an awareness of the cross-government coordination that will be necessary to deliver on AI goals. A National AI strategy articulates the government's high-level view of its role in AI and how it will ensure that AI benefits the public.

Scoring: This is a desk research indicator. Countries receive a score of 100 if they have published a publicly available strategy. Countries receive a score of 50 if they have published a draft strategy, or have announced that they will be publishing an AI strategy in the past calendar year (since 1 December 2024). Countries receive a score of 0 if they have no strategy, or if their announcement of an in progress strategy was from before 1 December 2024.

Indicator: AI Advisory Council

Rationale: An AI Advisory council comprises AI experts who advise the government on matters related to AI development in the country. Access to experts from across industry and academia is important for a government's ability to develop informed AI policy, as AI is a highly specialised and technical subject. This can create information asymmetries between industry and policymakers that hinders pace and effectiveness of AI policies.⁵ This calls for governments to secure access to subject matter

⁴ Mulgan, G. (no date), 'Strategies, missions and whole of government action', Geoff Mulgan.

⁵ Clarke, S. and Whittlestone, J. (2022), 'A Survey of the Potential Long-term Impacts of AI: How AI Could Lead to Long-term Changes in Science, Cooperation, Power, Epistemics and Values', Proceedings of the 2022 AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society, pp. 192–202.

expertise, for example, through hiring, developing formal and informal networks with industry and academia, and/or use of strategic intelligence collection techniques for monitoring emerging trends.⁶

Scoring: This is a desk research indicator. Countries receive a score of 100 if they have established an AI council, which is ideally a multistakeholder body that advises on AI implementation and AI use in the country. The remit of the advisory council needs to be broader than just the development of a country's AI strategy itself. Countries receive a score of 50 if they have committed to the development of an AI Advisory council since 1 December 2024 but it has not been launched yet. Countries receive a score of 0 if they have not committed to making an AI advisory council, or if they committed to making one prior to 1 December 2024, but it is not yet functional.

Indicator: Publication of Strategy Updates

Rationale: This indicator assesses whether countries have published additional policy documentation beyond their National AI Strategy. Updating policy matters to the effectiveness of AI policy because AI is a quickly evolving field. Policy needs to be responsive to new risks and opportunities. Publishing strategy updates also demonstrates that AI is a priority for government.

Scoring: This is a desk research indicator. Countries receive a score of 100 if they have published more than one national strategy, an additional phase of their original AI strategy, or a separate strategy implementation plan. Countries receive a score of 50 if they have made a commitment to publishing one of the above strategy updates since 1 December 2024. Countries receive a score of 0 if they have published no updates since the original strategy publication, and if they have no commitments to publish updates. Countries receive a score of N/A if they published their first national AI strategy since 1 December 2024, as in this case the strategy itself is so recent that it would not need to be updated.

Indicator: Intention to Participate in International Cooperation on AI R&D

Rationale: International cooperation is an important aspect of AI readiness because AI developments - and challenges are not constrained by borders. And because some AI opportunities are global in scale. Similarly, establishing international networks for research enhances the global relevance, credibility, and reputation of AI research. Cross-border R&D efforts are also bigger than the sum of their parts, and often more extensive and ambitious than what could be achieved at a national level. For example, enabling access to more resources through compute and data partnerships, demonstrating the benefits of collaboration and shaping an important multiplier effect.

Scoring: This is a desk research indicator. Countries receive a score of 100 if they have active joint R&D collaborations with other countries, bilateral R&D agreements, co-fund research initiatives or efforts, or host major international AI events which include an R&D focus. Countries receive a score of 50 if they participate in forums, sign Memoranda of Understanding (or similar documents), or set out

⁶ OECD (2025), Steering AI's future: Strategies for anticipatory governance, 32nd edn, OECD Artificial Intelligence Papers.

general commitments to R&D. Countries receive a score of 0 if there is no evidence of their international engagement in this area.

Indicator: Intention to Participate in International Cooperation on AI Governance

Rationale: AI governance needs cooperation because some AI risks and opportunities are global in scale. Yet, the largest and most capable AI models are increasingly developed by a small number of companies concentrated in the US and China.⁷ One key target of AI governance measures taken to manage AI impacts are AI models and companies. Countries who do not have jurisdiction over these companies naturally have less of a say in the development of AI. International cooperation provides a route for all countries to have a voice in AI governance as AI development at the frontier becomes increasingly concentrated in only a few countries.

Scoring: This is a desk research indicator. Countries receive a score of 100 if they are actively engaged in international AI governance cooperation. This may include engaged participation (not just attendance) in global AI governance fora, contributing to international AI safety or governance standards, or the presence of national government officials on international AI ethics or AI governance bodies. Countries receive a score of 50 if they set out a general commitment to international AI governance cooperation in strategy or policy documents without specific initiatives defined, or if they are undertaking early-stage engagement in this area (for example, having signed declarations, attended governance summits, or assumed observer status in relevant AI governance fora). Countries receive a score of 0 if there is no evidence of their international engagement in this area.

Dimension: Policy Commitment

Indicator: Actions, outputs, and timeline included in AI Strategy

Rationale: Strong AI governance needs not just a coherent vision, but also clear mechanisms for its implementation. A detailed roadmap with timelines and outcomes facilitates all government entities' adoption of, and implementation of, relevant actions in order to support the delivery of the AI strategy.

Scoring: Countries receive a score of 100 if they have published a clear robust roadmap with specific actions and evidence of implementation planning. This includes, for example, specific ministries designated to carry out specific actions, a clearly specified timeline, and/ or methods for monitoring which have been clearly outlined. Countries receive a score of 50 if they have listed specific actions to take in the body of the strategy, but do not have a specific roadmap. Countries receive a score of 0 if they do not have a roadmap or specific actions listed in their strategy.

⁷ Epoch AI (2024), 'Data on AI Models', Epoch AI.

Indicator: Responsible Agency for AI in Strategy

Rationale: Like any policy area, AI policy needs clear responsibility for implementation. AI policy depends on coordinated government action, and a country's strategy must make clear which agency or agencies will be responsible for carrying out different parts of the strategy. In the case of national AI strategies, common agencies that take on this task are ICT agencies, economics or finance agencies, or education, science, and innovation agencies.⁸ We endeavour to remain agnostic on whether a new body must be set up or whether existing ministries/departments are used as responsible agencies.

Scoring: Countries receive a score of 100 if their National AI Strategy specifies which ministries, departments or bodies should carry out which aspects of the strategy. Countries receive a score of 0 if they do not specify specific institutions tasked with carrying out different parts of the strategy.

Indicator: Budget allocation announced

Rationale: Agencies tasked within an AI strategy will require funding to deliver on government priorities. A particular challenge for many countries is the sustainability of funding sources. While some countries may be in the position to fund AI policy initiatives through internal budgets and reliable public-private partnerships, others face challenges with relying on outside funding for aid agencies that can be short term or uncertain.⁹

Scoring: Countries receive a score of 100 if they have announced a total, overarching figure for how much they will be investing in AI development across their whole strategy. Countries receive a score of 50 if they allocated some funds for specific projects, but have not provided an overall figure. Countries receive a score of 0 if they have not clearly allocated a budget for their AI initiatives.

Indicator: Membership in, or signatory to, major global AI initiatives

Rationale: International cooperation is crucial for AI readiness, and especially important for countries in the Global South, where lower institutional capacity might limit AI policy advancement. Inclusive forums allow a wider range of countries to have a voice in AI governance.

Scoring: Countries receive a score of 100 if they are a member of GPAI, [OECD.AI](#), COMSTATS, CAHAI, or The Framework Convention on Artificial Intelligence. Countries receive a score of 0 if they are not a member of any of these fora.

⁸ Galindo, L., Perset, K. and Sheeka, F. (2021), An overview of national AI strategies and policies, OECD Publishing, Paris.

⁹ Folorunso, A., Olanipekun, K., Adewumi, T. and Samuel, B. (2024), 'A policy framework on AI usage in developing countries and its impact', *Global Journal of Engineering and Technology Advances*, 21(1), pp. 154–166.

Infrastructure Pillar

To what extent can a government harness AI to benefit the public? To the extent that...

...there is adequate compute capacity and enabling technical infrastructure that the government and other actors can rely on over the long term to develop and use AI. There is sufficient, high-quality data for working on a wide range of problems using AI that is accessible and flows securely within and across the border.

Dimension: Compute Capacity

Indicator: Public cloud providers with AI deployment capacity chips

Rationale: Actors need access to computing resources to develop and deploy AI models. These resources can be found in the cloud, on premises, or on edge devices.¹⁰ Large AI projects typically rely on servers with AI-capable chips housed in data centres, while smaller projects may use an organisation's own server rooms. Data centres might be owned by a single company, such as a major AI firm or a government research institute, or their resources can be rented from cloud service providers. The type of chips in a data centre determines what AI tasks it can support. Chips are needed for both deployment and training of AI models..

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Number of compute regions of public cloud providers with AI deployment capacity chips. Sourced from [Oxford Institute of the Internet](#)¹¹

Indicator: Public cloud providers with AI training capacity chips

Rationale: As above.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Number of compute regions of public cloud providers with AI training capacity chips. Sourced from [Oxford Institute of the Internet](#)

Indicator: Publicly-owned supercomputers

Rationale: Publicly-owned compute resources provide the government with greater control over access to compute. This helps government to drive specific policy goals. In this instance, government can also help to fill in the capital investment requirements of computing. Additionally, the government

¹⁰ Jacobides, M. G., Brusoni, S. and Candelon, F. (2021), 'The Evolutionary Dynamics of the Artificial Intelligence Ecosystem', *Strategy Science*, 6(4), pp. 412–435.

¹¹ Hawkins, Zoe Jay and Lehdonvirta, Vili and Wu, Boxi, AI Compute Sovereignty: Infrastructure Control Across Territories, Cloud Providers, and Accelerators (June 20, 2025). Available at SSRN: <https://ssrn.com/abstract=5312977> or <http://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.5312977>

has greater control over access to compute resources owned by public academic institutions or government.¹² This can give the government options for using the resources to drive policy goals such as AI development in priority domains, or increasing access among some actor groups.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Number of public or public-private AI supercomputers. Sourced from [Epoch AI](#) (December 2025)

Indicator: Domestic data centres

Rationale: Although data centre services can be accessed internationally, governments increasingly prefer domestic infrastructure. From a performance perspective, domestic data centres can offer faster latency and cheaper data transfer costs for users of AI applications.¹³ From a security perspective, using data centres in a foreign jurisdiction raises concerns for businesses and governments who store their data there. Lastly from a policy perspective, there are greater data and AI policy options and enforcement possibilities when a data centre is located within a territorial jurisdiction.¹⁴

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Number of data centres. Sourced from [Data Centre Map](#)

Dimension: Enabling technical infrastructure

Indicator: Technical cybersecurity capacity

Rationale: Having strong cybersecurity measures ensures that other enabling infrastructure for AI is resilient to attacks, and also ensures that this infrastructure can support the AI ecosystem.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Technical Measures Score. Sourced from [ITU Cybersecurity Index](#)

Indicator: Energy Independence

Rationale: Countries need a significant amount of energy in order to build, train, and deploy AI technologies. This energy can be bought from other countries, but if a country has enough energy resources to power this themselves, this makes them significantly more resilient to shifting geopolitical dynamics, and helps to support their AI sovereignty.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Average of (1) Percentage difference between electricity imports and exports as share of electricity demand and (2) Percentage difference between electricity imports and exports as share of energy demand. Both sourced from [Our World in Data](#) (adapted from Ember)

¹² Shearer, E., Davies, M. and Lawrence, M. (2024), 'The role of public compute', Ada Lovelace Institute.

¹³ Lehdonvirta, V., Wu, B. and Hawkins, Z. (2024), Compute North vs. Compute South: The Uneven Possibilities of Compute-based AI Governance Around the Globe, OSF.

¹⁴ Hawkins, Z., Lehdonvirta, V. and Wu, B. (2025), AI Compute Sovereignty: Infrastructure Control Across Territories, Cloud Providers, and Accelerators, SSRN Scholarly Paper No. 5312977.

Indicator: Electricity access

Rationale: Electricity is essential to the development and deployment of AI technologies. If a country has high levels of electricity access, this will help AI technologies to be used across the country and economy, and help to reduce the risk that certain regions or populations will be left out.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Share of total population with access to electricity (%). Sourced from [Energy progress report](#)

Indicator: Broadband speed

Rationale: Basic IT infrastructure is a precondition for other AI infrastructure and AI adoption. Stable internet connectivity and telecommunications infrastructure are necessary for creating and deploying AI applications. For the creation of data and the deployment of AI applications, connection and access to IT infrastructure, such as stable internet connectivity and telecommunications infrastructure (as below) is necessary and remains a top initial priority in countries where it is not widespread.¹⁵

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Download speed (MBps). Sourced from [Ookla](#)

Indicator: 4G Coverage

Rationale: As above, basic IT infrastructure is essential for AI development and use. Mobile data coverage is an essential part of this, as it helps people in different regions throughout the country access AI technologies, and also helps to ensure data representativeness.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. 4G Coverage. Sourced from [GSMA Mobile Connectivity Index](#)

Indicator: Secure internet servers

Rationale: Reliable IT infrastructure is a precondition for the adoption of AI. Secure internet servers are a component of this basic infrastructure, essential for data security.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Number of secure Internet servers (per 1 million people). Sourced from the [World Bank](#)

Dimension: Data quality

Indicator: Household access to internet

Rationale: AI needs comprehensive, representative, and accurate training data. Countries need to have high levels of internet penetration, with a high percentage of households with internet access in

¹⁵ Folorunso, A., Olanipekun, K., Adewumi, T. and Samuel, B. (2024)

order to ensure that the data about the country is comprehensive and representative when it is used in AI systems.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. % of households with access to the internet. Sourced from [ITU](#)

Indicator: Open Data portal

Rationale: Businesses often cite access to quality public data as a barrier to AI adoption and development. Open data can be a key input for AI development, and open data portals make this data accessible to a wide range of actors.

Scoring: Countries receive a score of 100 if they have an open data portal, a score of no if they do not have an open data portal, and a score of N/A if information about whether they have an open data portal is not accessible. Combination of desk research and secondary sources, including World Bank and ITU.

Indicator: International trade in digitally deliverable services

Rationale: Ensuring data can be shared securely across borders is critical for data availability. Companies operating across multiple jurisdictions cite this as a key barrier to AI adoption. To address this in the context of the wider digital economy, countries have been developing cross border data flow agreements that enable sharing of data between countries with data protection regulations.¹⁶ The amount of digital trade is an indicator that gets at this ease of the flow of data.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Value of digitally deliverable services. Sourced from [UNCTAD](#)

Indicator: Socioeconomic divide in connectivity

Rationale: It is important for AI to benefit all segments of the population. Addressing socioeconomic divides is essential for ensuring AI benefits are widespread and not limited to certain groups.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Device affordability for lowest 40%. Sourced from [GSMA](#)

Indicator: Gender divide in connectivity

Rationale: As above, it is important for AI to benefit all segments of the population. Addressing socioeconomic divides is essential for ensuring AI benefits are widespread and not limited to certain groups.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Gender gap in mobile internet. Sourced from [GSMA](#)

¹⁶ Spiezia, V. and Tscheke, J. (2020), International agreements on cross-border data flows and international trade: A statistical analysis, OECD Science, Technology and Industry Working Papers, No. 2020/09.

Governance Pillar

To what extent can a government harness AI to benefit the public? To the extent that...

...the government has clear governance principles that it promotes to shape how AI can be developed and adopted while protecting people's rights and societal interests. These principles are promoted through its own public sector practices and structures, supporting their wider implementation, and ensuring an adaptive environment for regulatory compliance with respect to AI.

Dimension: Governance Principles

Indicator: AI Ethics Principles published

Rationale: Developing AI governance principles has become a foundational step in a country's approach to AI governance. They provide consistent norms that can guide governments in other AI governance measures. While each country sets its own principles, many look to global frameworks like the OECD AI Principles.¹⁷ and UNESCO's Recommendation on the Ethics of AI.¹⁸ These initiatives, and national principles, often have common values such as transparency, accountability, safety, security, and sustainability.

Scoring: This is a desk research indicator. Countries receive a score of 100 if they have clearly recognisable AI ethics principles published and publicly available, and with sufficient depth to provide a clear understanding of AI norms and/or non-negotiables that could be applied within and beyond the public sector. These may be contained within the country's National AI Strategy (with sufficient depth) or be found in a separate document, policy, or even legislation. Countries receive a score of 50 if they have draft principles shared publicly, or have announced their intention to develop principles within the past year. Countries receive a score of 0 if there is no evidence of any intention to develop principles.

Indicator: Data protection regulation

Rationale: AI introduces new risks to individual privacy through interference from data and increased surveillance. Data protection regulations play a crucial role in a government's AI readiness to manage these risks.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Has regulation (100) or doesn't have regulation (0). Sourced from [UNCTAD](#)

¹⁷ OECD (no date), 'AI principles', *OECD*.

¹⁸ UNESCO (2021), Recommendation on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence, UNESCO Digital Library.

Indicator: Algorithmic transparency

Rationale: An essential component of data protection regulation is to maintain people's access to the logic behind AI decision-making and to enable them to challenge decisions made by AI technologies which affect them.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Law establishing a right to Algorithmic Transparency. Sourced from [Centre for AI and Digital Policy](#)

Indicator: Cybersecurity regulation

Rationale: Cybersecurity is an essential element of ensuring that countries are able to develop and deploy safe and secure AI systems.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Has cybersecurity regulations. Sourced from [ITU Cybersecurity Index](#).

Dimension: Regulatory Compliance

Indicator: Participation in ISO AI standards committee

Rationale: The ISO AI Standards committee focuses on developing and providing standards and guidance on developing AI applications. Membership in this committee shows that countries are committed to aligning with international standards and best practices in terms of AI development and use.

Scoring: Countries receive a score of 100 if they are a member body of the [ISO](#) AI standards committee. Countries receive a score of 67 if they are a correspondent member. Countries receive a score of 33 if they are a subscriber member. Countries receive a score of 0 if they are not involved in the committee.

Indicator: Use of regulatory sandboxes

Rationale: A sandbox is a controlled environment where companies, researchers and other actors can test AI products under the supervision of regulators without real-world harm being caused. This indicator assesses the extent to which countries have a desire and commitment to advance AI innovation by allowing for the safe development of new technologies through the use of sandboxes.

Scoring: Countries receive a score of 100 if they have national-level sandboxes that are specifically used for AI purposes. Countries receive a score of 50 if they have national level sandboxes in areas such as fintech or medtech which could include AI use cases, if they have sub-national level AI sandboxes, or a planned AI sandbox which has not yet been implemented. Countries receive a score of 0 if they do not have any sandboxes that are AI-related.

Indicator: Data protection authority

Rationale: The effectiveness of a government's regulatory approach relies on having institutions empowered to enforce regulations. An independent data protection authority is especially critical for regulating AI use in the public sector.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Has (100) doesn't have/no one singular (0) Data Protection Authority. Sourced from [WB Govtech Index](#)

Indicator: Consumer protections authority

Rationale: AI products and services developed for public use should be monitored and assessed by an independent authority to determine their safety and security.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Has (100) doesn't have (0) a consumer protection contact point. Sourced from [UNCTAD](#)

Indicator: Competitions authorities

Rationale: A competitive AI sector is important for catering to different client needs and for innovation. Competition is not inevitable in the AI industry, and governments play an important role in encouraging it. Competition authorities can enforce antitrust laws and promote a level playing field.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Sourced from [GIRAI](#)

Public Sector Adoption Pillar

To what extent can a government harness AI to benefit the public? To the extent that...

...the **government's digital policy** encourages testing how AI can help to solve public sector challenges. Where AI proves effective, the government scales AI solutions, demonstrating this through its **e-government delivery** capabilities.

Dimension: Government digital policy

Indicator: AI in the public sector strategy document

Rationale: Governments need to develop a view of what they would like to achieve, and what it is possible to achieve, using AI in their public sector, as well as how AI projects should be run by teams across government. This requires a strategy or policy to articulate ambitions and practices. Beyond

this, AI projects require talent, financing, and support to ensure sustainability¹⁹, which a public sector AI strategy or policy can also help coordinate.

Scoring: This is a desk research indicator. Countries receive a score of 100 if they have a published set of principles or clear mention within a government document (such as their National AI Strategy) which outlines how the country intends to use AI within the public sector. Countries receive a score of 50 if they have announced they will be developing a strategy since 1 December 2024. Countries receive a score of 0 if they do not have a strategy document, and have not made an announcement that they are developing one.

Indicator: Government AI training programmes

Rationale: Governments need staff with both technical and soft skills to develop and deliver AI projects. Even when the government is procuring an AI system from an external provider, there are concerns that a lack of technical expertise in government lead to dependence on technology providers and inability to fully understand AI systems.²⁰ Training programmes are an important way to build this expertise within the public sector.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Public sector AI skills development score. Sourced from [Global Index on Responsible AI](#)

Indicator: Use of service standards and evaluations

Rationale: Governments need to evaluate AI solutions carefully to ensure they are effective and deliver for the people who will be using those services. Service standards and evaluation practices are important ways to assess this in government. This process can include feasibility studies, pilots, and post-implementation monitoring.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Average of score for (1) service standards availability and (2) measuring service delivery. Sourced from [World Bank Govtech Index](#)

Indicator: Data governance policy for public administration

Rationale: Developing and deploying AI solutions requires high-quality government datasets. For data to meet the requirements of AI developers, datasets must, among other quality criteria, follow established standards, remain consistent, use appropriate formats, and include metadata.²¹ A data governance policy helps to ensure the quality of such government data.

¹⁹ Ramizo, G., Jr. (2021)

²⁰ World Economic Forum (2020), AI Procurement in a Box: AI Government Procurement Guidelines.

²¹ Majithia, N., Carey-Wilson, T. and Simperl, E. (2025), 'A framework for AI-ready data', The Open Data Institute (The ODI).

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Average of score for data governance entity and data governance strategy. Sourced from [World Bank Govtech Index](#)

Indicator: Govtech support policy

Rationale: The government plays an important role in facilitating collaborations with AI providers. GovTech initiatives can encourage the procurement of more innovative and effective solutions. A policy to support the GovTech industry in the country can support industry and facilitate collaboration.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Govtech support policy. Sourced from [World Bank Govtech Index](#)

Dimension: e-Government delivery

Indicator: Digitisation of services

Rationale: AI can be used to improve public services. The digitisation of services demonstrates that government has the delivery methods necessary to incorporate AI-enabled services.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. E-government Index score. Sourced from UN [E-gov survey](#), [Online services index](#)

Indicator: Digital public infrastructure

Rationale: Digital public infrastructure, such as inter-agency data sharing platforms or payment platforms, support the development of AI solutions and delivery of AI-enabled services to people at scale, across the country. This infrastructure is what connects data and hardware, such as data centres or government data, to the services government delivers²². It can support the development of AI solutions by improving data availability and quality of training and post-training data for models across government²³. Additionally, digital public infrastructure could lead to greater impacts of AI solutions that the government sets up, by connecting more of the public to digital systems, and creating opportunities for deployment at larger scales.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Presence of digital ID system, payment system, and data exchange system. Sourced from [UCL IIPP](#) DPI Map

Indicator: Government interoperability framework

²² Eaves, D., Mazzucato, M. and Vasconcellos, B. (2024), Digital public infrastructure and public value: What is 'public' about DPI?, UCL Institute for Innovation and Public Purpose, Working Paper Series (IIPP WP 2024-05).

²³ Nagar, S. and Eaves, D. (2024), Interactions Between Artificial Intelligence and Digital Public Infrastructure: Concepts, Benefits, and Challenges, arXiv.

Rationale: Using common standards for data and infrastructure across government helps increase the public sector's leverage as a buyer of AI systems. It also helps to avoid vendor lock-in, which is a common problem in digital government projects.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Has government Interoperability Framework. Sourced from [World Bank Govtech Index](#)

Indicator: E-procurement portal

Rationale: Public sector adoption of AI relies on the availability of providers who can collaborate with the government. An e-procurement portal makes procurement opportunities more accessible to AI providers and facilitates these collaborations.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. E-procurement portal exists (100) doesn't exist (0). Sourced from [World Bank procurement data](#)

Development and Diffusion Pillar

To what extent can a government harness AI to benefit the public? To the extent that...

...there is a **mature AI sector** that can meet the needs of local clients and consumers, and can push forward long-term AI innovation backed up by sufficient **human capital** to meet the demand for wider **AI technology diffusion** among industry players, researchers, and civil society who work on AI applications in their domains.

Dimension: Human capital

Indicator: Formal technical AI training at higher education level

Rationale: AI companies and other organisations need access to technical AI talent. Technical AI skills are seen as a significant barrier to AI in many regions, including Europe²⁴ and Africa²⁵. As a result, AI skills policies are common to national AI strategies, including initiatives focused on formal education in STEM or AI specific courses, as well as informal, upskilling, training and shorter courses.

Scoring: Countries receive a score of 100 if their National AI Strategy contains a commitment to formal technical training in AI in higher education with KPIs outlined. Countries receive a score of 50 if their strategy includes a commitment to training without clear metrics for progress or success. Countries

²⁴ Simons, W., Turrini, A. and Vivian, L. (2024), Artificial Intelligence: Economic Impact, Opportunities, Challenges, Implications for Policy, European Economy Discussion Paper 210, European Commission.

²⁵ Okolo, C.T. (2021), 'AI in the Global South: Opportunities and Challenges Towards More Inclusive Governance', International Journal of Innovative Research in Arts, Education and Technology, 2(1),

receive a score of 0 if they either have no National AI Strategy, or their strategy does not include a commitment to this.

Indicator: Visa or immigration policies to attract AI talent

Rationale: The technical AI talent pool is a significant barrier to AI development in many regions. Visa and immigration policies are another lever governments can pull to attract AI talent from other countries and remedy this problem.

Scoring: Countries receive a score of 100 if they have a tech talent visa. Countries receive a score of 50 if they have committed to establishing a tech talent visa. Countries receive a score of 0 if they do not have a tech talent visa and have not committed to making one.

Indicator: Graduates in STEM

Rationale: A skilled population is needed to back the domestic AI sector and support wider adoption of AI. Graduates in STEM fields are a key source of technical talent for AI companies and other sectors.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. % of graduates in STEM. Sourced from [UNESCO](#)

Indicator: Brain drain

Rationale: It is essential for countries to not only train students and residents in AI skills, but also to retain the AI talent already in the country. This indicator measures the extent to which countries are able to retain highly skilled workers.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Measure of human flight and brain drain. Sourced from The World Economy's [Brain Drain Index](#)

Indicator: Github activity

Rationale: AI companies and organisations need access to technical AI talent to develop and deploy AI models. Github activity can be an indicator of the size and activity level of a country's technical AI talent pool.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Number of developers on Github. Sourced from [Github](#)

Dimension: AI Sector maturity

Indicator: Advanced AI companies

Rationale: Having domestic AI companies is important for the development of AI solutions which cater specifically to the socio-economic needs, languages, and values of a country's population. In addition, the actions of AI companies are a key point of governance and regulation and having

domestic AI companies that are relied on gives greater opportunities for a country's AI governance to be effective.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Number of notable AI models. Sourced from [Epoch AI](#)

Indicator: AI unicorns

Rationale: The existence of unicorns, startups valued at over 1 billion USD, indicates the presence of a mature domestic AI sector.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Total valuation of all unicorns in a country as a % of GDP. Sourced from [Crunchbase](#) and [CB Insights](#).

Indicator: Venture capital availability

Rationale: Access to funding is essential for the growth and innovation of the domestic AI sector. Venture capital is a key funding source for companies across growth stages.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. 4.2.3 Late-stage VC deal count, % global VC. Sourced from [Global Innovation Index](#)

Indicator: Government (or PPP) AI startup funding programme

Rationale: Many early stage AI companies rely on government funding and grants. Having a startup funding programme focused on AI companies will help to support more companies to grow and scale, strengthening a country's AI ecosystem.

Scoring: Countries receive a score of 100 if there is evidence that they have an established government or public-private partnership AI startup funding programme with the budget outlined. In order to count, the funding programme must specify that AI is part of their focus. Countries receive a score of 50 if they have committed to establishing an AI startup funding programme. Countries receive a score of 0 if they do not have a startup fund planned.

Indicator: Computer software spending

Rationale: Widespread adoption of AI requires organisations across the economy to make investments in AI and to make structural changes. Computer software spending can be an indicator of these broader investments in technology that enable AI adoption.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Computer software spending as % of GDP. Sourced from [Global Innovation Index](#)

Dimension: AI technology diffusion

Indicator: Adoption of AI among local businesses

Rationale: Many of the benefits from AI, including productivity gains and improved quality in essential services rely on its deployment across sectors. This relies on organisations across the economy making investments in AI, learning how to use AI to the benefit of their customers and clients, and making structural and procedural changes to extract value from AI.

For adoption to reach critical priorities and not to be concentrated in 'easy' sectors, it may require the government to use push and pull mechanisms to encourage adoption. As with academic AI research, industrial R&D funding and R&D programmes, can target priority sectors or challenge areas, such as energy or healthcare.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Survey score for 'Adoption of AI among local businesses: new products and business models'. World Economic Forum Executive Opinion Survey

Indicator: Number of AI research papers

Rationale: AI research contributes to the domestic AI sector by generating ideas that can be translated into new businesses or business applications. In addition, AI research could lead to breakthroughs in areas that the market would otherwise neglect. Indeed, researchers identified that AI research conducted by academia is complementary to, and leads to more novel work than, industry research projects²⁶.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Number of AI papers. Sourced from [Scimago](#)

Indicator: Research Institute for AI

Rationale: An AI research institute can spearhead AI research and direct funding into priority areas. It can also coordinate research across different groups, or potentially across different institutions, and can support the creation of a network of AI researchers.

Scoring: Countries receive a score of 100 if they have at least one AI research institute, either a national AI research institute or an AI research institute housed at a university or research centre. Countries receive a score of 50 if they have announced that they have plans to make an AI research institute, but it has not been implemented yet. Countries receive a score of 0 if they do not have an AI research institute based within their country.

Indicator: Research and Development spending

Rationale: The benefits of AI rely on it being deployed across sectors. Governments and industry need to invest in research and development (R&D) to develop applications in different sectors.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Gross expenditure on R&D, % GDP. Sourced from [Global Innovation Index](#)

²⁶ Liang, L., Zhuang, H., Zou, J. and Acuna, D. E. (2024), The complementary contributions of academia and industry to AI research, arXiv.

Resilience Pillar

To what extent can a government harness AI to benefit the public? To the extent that...

...the government manages the social, economic, and environmental challenges brought by a **societal transition** towards widespread AI adoption. This includes actively monitoring and preparing for new risks to national **safety and security** as AI development and diffusion progresses.

Dimension: Societal transition

Indicator: Labour rights

Rationale: There are risks to workers from both AI development and deployment. AI deployment can lead to risks to workers from using AI in the workplace in ways that result in discrimination, surveillance and information asymmetries²⁷. During AI development, AI companies also rely on a human workforce to perform tasks like data labelling and data annotation, and employers have been criticised for its exploitation of people through lack of fair pay, and poor working conditions²⁸. These data tasks are typically outsourced to low-skilled workers in developing countries²⁹. As the kind of tasks that AI performs expand, these practices may move towards high skilled labor too³⁰.

Both kinds of risks to workers from AI require workplace regulations to protect workers. For some risks, existing laws in some countries are relevant, including discrimination and gender equality laws, and data privacy laws³¹. However, other practices may be unregulated currently or legislation may not be being enforced.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Index score. Sourced from [Labour Rights Index](#)

Indicator: Digital skills

Rationale: AI has the potential to undermine the public's information environment by scaling up disinformation and misinformation. Digital skills in the population are a necessary foundation for people to be equipped with the awareness of these risks.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Digital Skills Index. Sourced from [Network Readiness Index](#)

Indicator: Government effectiveness

²⁷ Hassel, A. and Özkiziltan, D. (2023)

²⁸ Fraz, A. (2023), 'Hidden Workers powering AI', National Centre for AI.

²⁹ Okolo, C.T. (2021)

³⁰ Benaich, N. (Air Street Press) (2025)

³¹ Hassel, A. and Özkiziltan, D. (2023)

Rationale: An effective government is needed to ensure that any disruptions AI causes to society are managed appropriately and that citizens and residents are protected.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Deviation from the global mean (-2.5 to 2.5). Sourced from World Bank [World Governance Indicators](#)

Indicator: Energy consumption from nuclear and renewables

Rationale: For AI to benefit the population it needs to not contribute to the destruction of the environment or undermine environmental goal. AI's relationship with environmental sustainability is multidirectional, e.g. negative impacts from energy consumption for training and deployment and positive applications. Governments can contribute to sustainability by lowering CO2 emissions from their electricity grids.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. % of energy consumption from either renewables or nuclear. Sourced from [Our World in Data](#)

Dimension: Safety and security

Indicator: Monitoring systemic AI risks

Rationale: As AI models grow more capable and widespread, the scale and severity of risks increase. These include chemical, biological, radiological, and nuclear (CBRN) threats stemming from AI lowering barriers to weapon development. Additionally, risks arise from advanced AI systems acting autonomously in ways misaligned with human values and goals, including losing control over models that can self-improve³².

Monitoring risks and capabilities of AI systems allows for governments to ensure their wider AI governance approach remains responsive to emerging risks as AI capabilities and applications develop.

Scoring: Countries receive a score of 100 if their National AI Strategy includes a commitment to monitoring the systemic risks of AI with at least one specific initiative listed which demonstrates a tangible commitment to doing so. A country receives a score of 50 if their National AI Strategy mentions that the country is aware of and will monitor risks, but does not include a specific, tangible initiative set up to do so. Countries receive a score of 0 if their National AI Strategy does not mention this, or if they do not have a National AI Strategy.

Indicator: AI safety or AI security institute

³² Frontier Model Forum (2025), 'Risk Taxonomy and Thresholds for Frontier AI Frameworks', Frontier Model Forum.

Rationale: AI safety institutes are prominent routes for governments to monitor and prepare for emerging AI risks. These institutes support the development of technical tools for safe and secure AI, and also contribute to global AI resilience.

Scoring: Countries receive a score of 100 if they are a member of the International Network of AI Safety Institutes or if they have established their own AI safety institute. Countries receive a score of 50 if they have committed to establishing an AI safety institute since 1 December 2024. Countries receive a score of 0 if they have no AI safety institute and have not committed to making one.

Indicator: Cybersecurity agencies

Rationale: AI deployment in critical infrastructure, such as energy and military systems, can cause serious harm because of its link to critical parts of people's lives as well as the security of the country. One way that this infrastructure may be made vulnerable through the use of AI is due to cybersecurity risks. Governments need to ensure that AI systems in these sectors are robust and secure by updating cybersecurity standards and regulations.

Scoring: Secondary source indicator. Has (100) or does not have (0) a cybersecurity agency. Sourced from [ITU](#)

Get in touch!

We welcome thoughts and feedback on the index. We also invite countries to submit evidence of their work on AI readiness, especially as it pertains to the indicators measured in the Index. **To get in touch with us, please contact** research@oxfordinsights.com